Social Media Engagement Analysis Using Excel: Findings Report

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1. Objective

To analyse sample social media post data in Excel and find out which posts and post types receive the most engagement.

2. Dataset

The dataset contains 15 simulated posts across 5 post types (Text, Image, Poll, Video, Reel), with 3 posts per type. Columns: Post ID, Date, Post Type, Likes, Comments, Shares and Total Engagement. The data is sample data generated for practice, not taken from a real account.

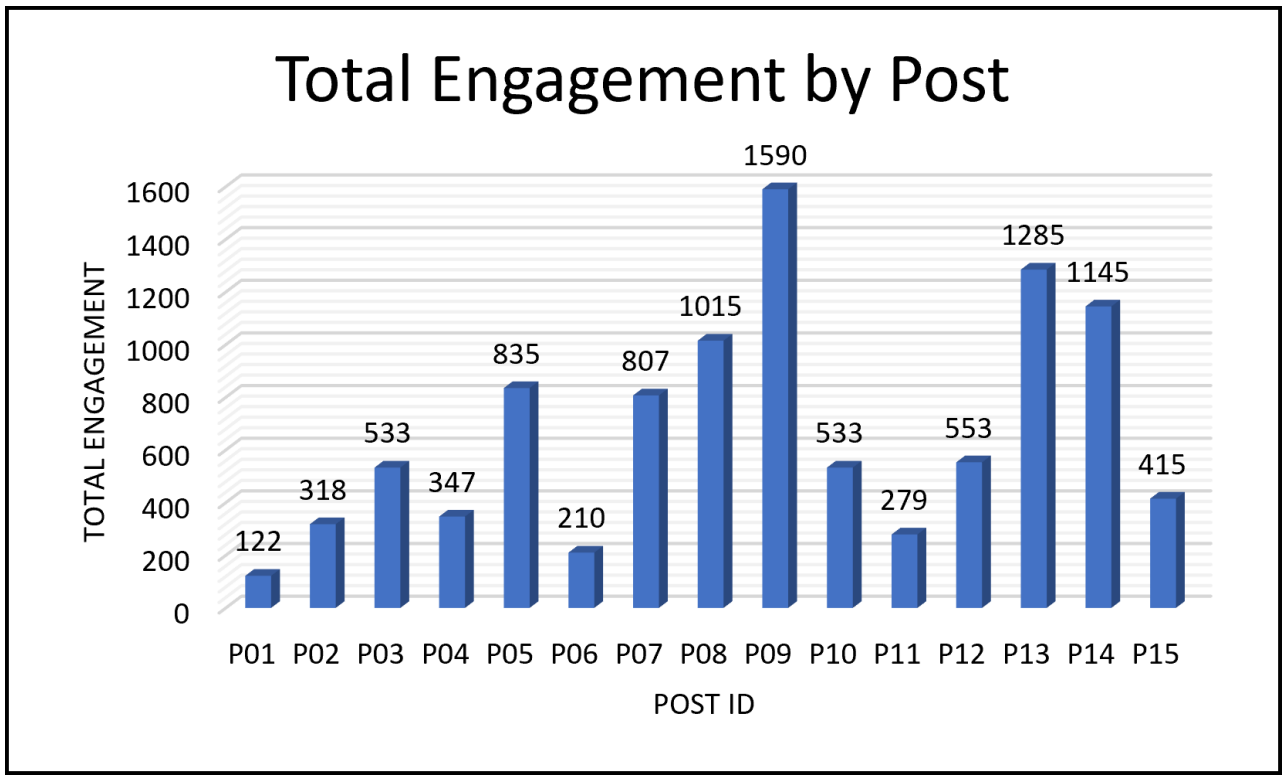
3. Method

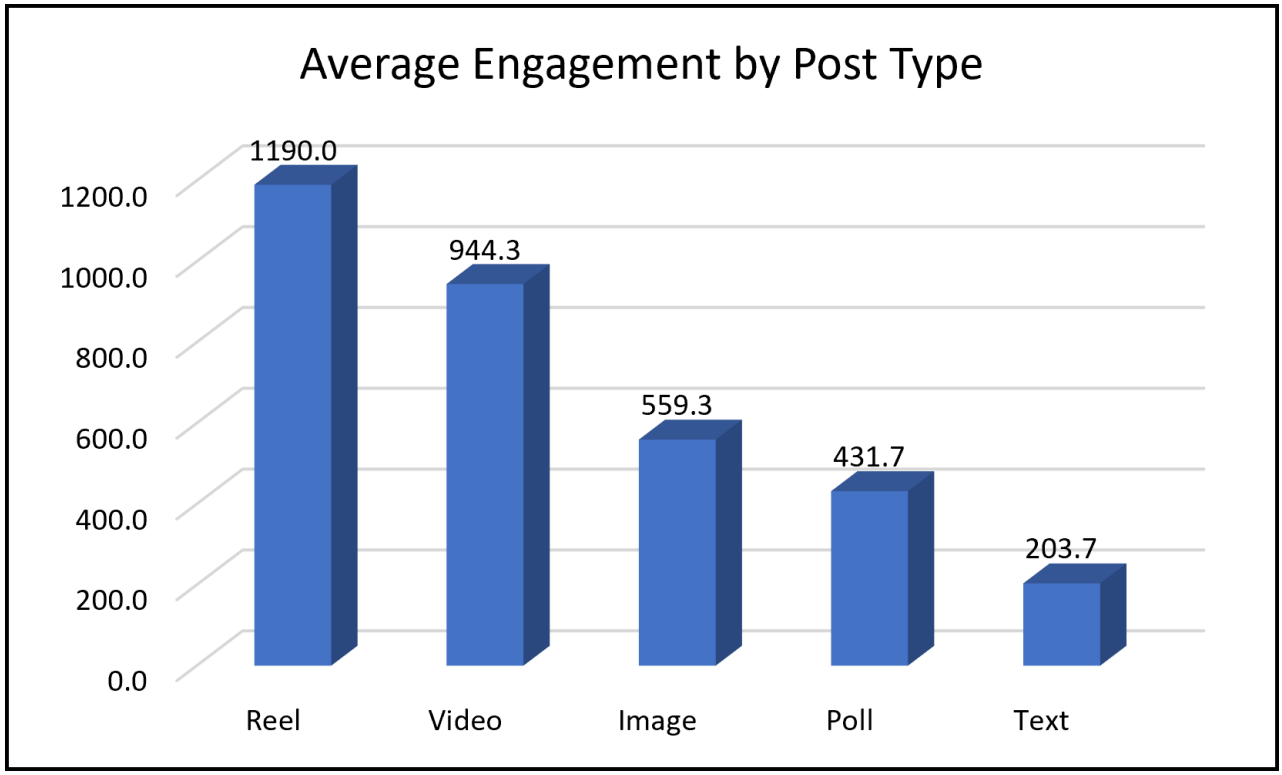
- **Total Engagement** per post = Likes + Comments + Shares (`=D2+E2+F2`).
- **Top post** found with `MAX` and `INDEX/MATCH`.
- **Post type comparison** built with `COUNTIF`, `AVERAGEIF` and `SUMIF`, with absolute references (`$C$2:$C$16`) so ranges do not shift when formulas are filled down.
- **Ratios** (comments per like, shares per like) calculated per post type to compare the kind of engagement.
- **Charts:** a column chart of total engagement by post, and a column chart of average engagement by post type.

4. Results

Highest-engagement post: P09, a Reel, with **1,590** total engagements (1,350 likes, 120 comments, 120 shares).

Post Type	Posts	Avg Engagement	Comments % of Likes	Shares % of Likes
Reel	3	1,190.0	8.4%	8.9%
Video	3	944.3	8.7%	5.9%
Image	3	559.3	9.3%	6.0%
Poll	3	431.7	27.2%	5.6%
Text	3	203.7	8.1%	4.2%


Total Engagement by Post
TOTAL ENGAGEMENT
1600
1400
1200
1000
800
600
400
200
0
122
318
533
347
835
210
807
1015
1590
533
279
553
1285
1145
415
P01 P02 P03 P04 P05 P06 P07 P08 P09 P10 P11 P12 P13 P14 P15
POST ID


Average Engagement by Post Type
1200.0
1000.0
800.0
600.0
400.0
200.0
0.0
1190.0
944.3
559.3
431.7
203.7
Reel
Video
Image
Poll
Text

5. Observations

1. Reels and Videos clearly outperform other formats.

Reels averaged 1,190 total engagement per post and Videos 944.3, while Text averaged only 203.7. Reels earn about 5.8 times the engagement of Text. The five highest posts were all Reels or Videos, and the three lowest were all Text posts. This suggests short-form video should get most of the content effort.

2. Video has high potential but is less predictable.

Video totals ranged from 533 (P03) to 1,285 (P13), a spread of 752, while Text stayed within 122 to 279. Even the weakest Video beat every Text post, but results depended on the individual post, so a video is not a guaranteed win.

3. Likes dominate engagement, but Polls drive comments and Reels drive shares.

Likes make up about 85% of all engagement. Polls get 27.2% comments per like, about three times the 8 to 9% of other types, and Reels have the highest shares per like at 8.9% (Text: 4.2%). Polls are best for starting conversation, Reels for spreading content, and the right format depends on the goal.

6. Data Quality Note

While building the summary table, Video showed 2 posts instead of 3. The cause was formula ranges shifting when filled down. This was fixed by locking the ranges with absolute references, and the counts were then verified (3 posts per type).

7. Conclusion and Limitation

Conclusion: Reels and Videos generate the most engagement, Polls generate the most discussion, and Text posts perform lowest, so content planning should match the format to the goal (reach, shares or conversation).

Limitation: The data is simulated and covers only 15 posts, so the results are indicative rather than conclusive.